YAWP!

WRITING PROGRAM

Lesson Plan Day 1: Introduce Students to YAWP!

Overview: In this lesson, students will be introduced to the YAWP! assignment and create their YAWP! accounts.

Goals:
Students will…

- Understand the purpose and philosophy of the YAWP! assignment
- Read a sample essay
- Create YAWP! accounts and complete the Welcome Exercise

Teacher will…

- Explain YAWP!
- Facilitate brief discussion on sample essay
- Lead students through YAWP! account creation

Materials Needed:

- Slide deck
- Sample essay
- Student laptops/chromebooks and access to yawp.school

Instructions:

1. **Open with the game "2 Truths and Lie."** This is designed to simply engage students in a fun way at the top of the program.
2. **Define YAWP!**
    a. Using Walt Whitman's quote, define the term "yawp" for the students.
    b. Using the slides, discuss why we write. This creates shared context and understanding of "What's the point of this?"
3. **Read Sample Essay.** Don't overanalyze or get in the weeds here. Let students connect to it and then help them find the thesis statement.
4. **Onboard students to yawp.school**
    a. Use the instructions in the Resources (note: the website is simply "yawp.school" — there is no "www" or ".com")
    b. Instruct students to open the "Welcome to YAWP!" course, create a document, and complete the Welcome Exercise.